

Side Hustle Focus Guide

How to Stop Starting Projects and Start Finishing Them

Six months ago, you launched Project #4. Before that, it was #3. Before that, #2.

You've been "working on your side hustle" for two years. You can't point to a single finished project. Your day job pays the bills. Your side hustles pay for your learning.

This guide is for people who are stuck in the starting loop. If you recognize the pattern — start, stall, abandon, repeat — this is for you.

Page 2: The Starting Trap

Starting feels productive. It triggers the same dopamine response as finishing, but with none of the work. You get the thrill of a new idea, a fresh start, a clean slate.

Finishing is hard. It requires you to push through the boring middle parts, make decisions you don't have answers to, and ship something imperfect.

Here's what the starting trap looks like:

- You launch a new project every 2-4 weeks
- You spend more time researching than building
- You have domains, accounts, and half-finished accounts across multiple platforms
- You've attended more webinars about side hustles than you've worked on your actual side hustle
- Your friends think you're an entrepreneur. Your bank account disagrees.

The math is brutal: starting 5 projects and finishing 0 generates \$0. Starting 1 project and finishing it might generate \$1.

Progress isn't the number of projects you've started. It's the number you've finished.

Page 3: The Project Audit

Before you can focus, you need to know what you're actually working with.

Step 1: Write down every project.

Open a document. List every active project. Include: - The project name - When you started - Hours you've invested - Income generated (even if \$0)

Step 2: Categorize each one.

For each project, assign one label: - **Active and promising** — You're still working on it, it shows revenue potential, and you want to continue - **Idle but might return** — Hasn't been touched in 30+ days but you haven't given up on it - **Dead project** — You're not working on it and you don't want to, but you haven't officially quit

Step 3: Calculate the real numbers.

Add up all the hours you've invested across all projects. Add up all the income. Most people find they've spent 200+ hours and made less than \$100.

This isn't to make you feel bad. It's to show you the cost of staying in the starting loop.

The pattern test:

Look at your list. Are all your projects in the same category (e-commerce, content creation, freelance services) or scattered across random categories?

Projects that cluster in one category might share skills and audiences. That's useful information for your one-project decision.

Page 4: The One-Project Framework

You need to pick one project and officially archive the rest.

The four criteria:

1. **Revenue proof** — Has this project already made at least \$1? If not, is there a realistic path to first dollar within 30 days?
2. **Time to market** — Can this be launched or completed in under 30 days with focused effort?
3. **Skill leverage** — Does this project use skills you're already building? Or does it require starting from scratch?
4. **Emotional pull** — Do you genuinely want to work on this when you have free time? Or are you avoiding it?

Your one project should pass at least 3 of these 4 criteria.

The motorcycle app test:

Imagine your five projects are five drawers in your desk. Four are closed. One is open. Which drawer do you open first thing in the morning?

That drawer contains your real project.

The others are drawers you think you should open. The first one is the one you actually want to open.

Official archiving:

Move the other projects to an "Archive" folder. Not "Active." Not "Paused." Archive.

This matters because "paused" projects stay on your mental to-do list. Archived projects are closed.

Page 5: How to Kill Projects Gracefully

Letting go of a project feels like admitting failure.

It isn't.

A dead project is information. You learned something from building it. Now you close it and move on.

The official close-down:

For each project you're archiving, write down: - Why you started it - Why you stopped - What you learned

This takes 5 minutes and turns abandonment into learning.

The sunk cost trap:

You've invested 50 hours in Project #3. If you quit now, those 50 hours feel wasted.

They're not wasted. You spent 50 hours learning what doesn't work for you. That's valuable data.

The sunk cost is keeping you trapped. Every additional hour you pour into a dying project is another hour you don't spend on something with potential.

When to revive a dead project:

Only revive if you have new information that changes the equation — a new audience, a new skill, a new insight.

Revive with intention, not nostalgia.

Page 6: The Focus System

You've picked your one project. Now you need to work on it consistently.

The morning side hustle hour:

Set a daily alarm for 60 minutes before your day job. This time is sacred. No phone. No social media. No email.

You're building a muscle. The first week will feel unproductive. By week three, you'll notice the work compound.

One metric per week:

Don't track everything. Pick one number to improve each week.

Week 1: Revenue. Week 2: Email subscribers. Week 3: Lead inquiries.

Rotate through your most important metrics. This prevents overwhelm and creates clear weekly goals.

The weekly kill list:

Every Friday, write down everything you did NOT do this week.

This sounds strange, but it's powerful. It builds comfort with letting go. You're practicing the act of deciding what not to do.

Accountability:

Share your one project with one person. Not publicly. Just one person who knows what you're building and can ask you about it weekly.

This is enough to keep most people honest.

Page 7: The Finishing Ritual

Projects don't really end. They get shipped, abandoned, or evolved.

When you launch something — a product, a service, a piece of content — you should mark the moment.

The launch ritual:

Write down what you launched, when, and what you expected.

Then set a follow-up for 30 days later to review actual results.

This closes the loop. The project isn't just "out there" forever. It has a specific launch date and a review scheduled.

The failure ritual:

When a project doesn't work, write down: - What you tried - Why it didn't work - What you'd do differently

Then officially archive it.

Do not leave projects in limbo. limbo projects drain mental energy without producing anything.

Page 8: When You Feel Like Quitting

Most people feel like quitting around week 3. This is normal.

The initial excitement is gone. The finish line isn't visible yet. The work is repetitive.

Before you quit, ask yourself:

Is this burnout or failure?

Burnout is a signal that you're working too hard or in the wrong direction. Failure is a signal that this specific approach isn't working.

They're different problems.

Burnout response: Rest. Reduce hours. Reassess the goal.

Failure response: Change the approach. Not the project.

The quit test:

If you weren't already working on this project, would you start it today?

If no, why are you continuing?

If yes, recommit with fresh intention.

Page 9: Side Hustle Case Studies

Case Study 1: The Jack-of-All-Trades Freelancer

Sarah had 6 freelance services: copywriting, graphic design, social media, web dev, SEO, and email marketing. She was busy but not profitable.

She picked one: copywriting for SaaS companies.

Within 6 months, she had 3 consistent clients. Within a year, she was charging double her previous rates because she could speak the language of her niche.

Case Study 2: The Product Pivot

Mike launched a physical product brand. It failed. He launched a digital course. It failed. He launched a consultation service. It worked.

His "failures" weren't wasted — each taught him what his audience actually needed.

He eventually launched a product that combined everything he learned. It succeeded because he had years of direct feedback.

Case Study 3: The Content Focus

Jenna started a blog, a YouTube channel, a podcast, and a newsletter simultaneously. After 18 months, she had modest numbers across all four.

She picked one: the newsletter.

Six months later, the newsletter had more subscribers than all four channels combined. The audience preferred one focused channel over four scattered ones.

The lesson: audience doesn't want more from you. They want more of you.

Page 10: Next Steps

Your Bonus: Included

This guide is available in your Lemon Squeezy library.

If you already purchased: check your Lemon Squeezy library for the companion checklist version of this guide. It gives you a printable project audit worksheet, the one-project decision matrix, and the weekly focus tracker.

If you're new: the companion checklist PDF walks you through the project audit, the four criteria evaluation, and the archiving decision — with spaces to write everything down.

Your next actions:

1. Do the project audit (write down every project today)
2. Apply the four criteria to pick your one project
3. Archive everything else officially
4. Set your morning side hustle hour

The starting loop kept you busy without making progress. The one-project focus system changes that.

Pick your project. Archive the rest. Do the work.